Welcome to Northwind Robotics

Northwind Robotics Ltd. is a fictional company that designs warehouse robots. This handbook explains the policies that apply to every employee.

Northwind Robotics was founded in 2014 in Pune, India, by Asha Verma and Daniel Brooks. The company currently employs around 240 people across two offices.

Our core values are safety first, honest communication, and continuous learning. Questions about this handbook should be sent to the People Team at people@northwind.example.

Working Hours and Remote Work

Core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 16:00 IST, Monday to Friday. Outside core hours, employees may plan their own schedule as long as they work 40 hours per week.

Employees may work remotely up to three days per week. Remote work requires approval from your manager and a stable internet connection.

Employees who work from home receive a one-time home office allowance of INR 15,000 for a chair, desk or monitor.

Leave Policy

Full-time employees receive 24 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Up to 5 unused leave days can be carried over into the next year.

Employees also receive 10 days of paid sick leave per year. A medical certificate is required for sick leave longer than 3 consecutive days.

Parental leave is 26 weeks for the primary caregiver and 4 weeks for the secondary caregiver, both fully paid.

Leave requests must be submitted in the HR portal at least two weeks in advance, except for sick leave and emergencies.

Expenses and Travel

Business expenses must be submitted within 30 days of purchase through the expense tool, together with an itemised receipt.

For business travel, employees should book economy class flights. Hotel costs are reimbursed up to INR 6,000 per night.

The daily meal allowance during business travel is INR 1,500. Alcohol is not reimbursed.

Security and IT

All laptops must use full-disk encryption and lock automatically after 5 minutes of inactivity.

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long, and multi-factor authentication is mandatory for email and source code repositories.

Security incidents, including lost devices and suspected phishing emails, must be reported to security@northwind.example within 24 hours.

Learning and Development

Each employee has an annual learning budget of INR 50,000 for courses, books and conference tickets.

Employees may spend up to 4 hours per month of working time on approved learning activities.

New hires are paired with an onboarding buddy for their first 90 days. Performance reviews take place twice a year, in April and October.